ARTG 1250 Design Process Context & Systems

Explores common design practices, principles, and vocabularies, introducing the design process as a method of inquiry and problem solving through studio projects.

Emphasizes the importance of an awareness of audience and context in the creation of meaningful communications and experiences.

Explores the practice of design as an iterative process, offering students an opportunity to obtain an understanding of the value of systems thinking and the importance of feedback and exchange as a means for assessing the quality of design's effectiveness in helping users achieve their goals.

Time

Monday [redacted]. In person unless noted otherwise.

Instructor

Lauren McCafferty
[redacted]

Office Hours

Remote by Appointment or in person scheduled time 1:1

Objectives

The goal of this course is to expose the fundamentals of design as well as explore the three different focus areas through studio-based projects and assignments.

In this practice-based studio course, you will learn and experiment with a range of research and design methods to help you better understand and anticipate human intentions, actions, and experiences.

Giving feedback and listening to others' feedback is key. Responding to feedback with thoughtful questions and asking for clarification if needed is part of the process. Participation in class discussions and critiques is critical. It is essential that during these times you are actively participating in the review of your classmates' work and working to iterate your own work each week based on feedback you receive.

Structure

This is a studio course which means that class time will be spent working in class. Your work will be evaluated throughout the process via individual and group critiques which will give you a window into your performance and progress. Your overall grade will be based on your participation throughout the course and your progress as you learn the fundamentals of the design process. The course will include two individual mini projects, one group project, and one individual multi-week project.

- 40% Process: evaluating how you're progressing week to week, taking feedback from critiques and iterating on your projects. This includes experimenting with

different ways of working, tools used, and being able to articulate your learnings along the way.
- 40% Artifacts: bringing your project to class to be available for critiques with others. You're expected to upload your design prior to the beginning of class in Canvas. Uploads are due PRIOR to the beginning of class or it will be considered late unless noted otherwise.
- 20% Participation: actively participating in giving feedback to your classmates as well as completing any online readings and discussions
- Attendance: This is an in-person studio class. You are expected to attend in person unless noted otherwise. For sickness or emergencies - please email me ahead of class if you will be absent or it will be considered unexcused. Two or more unexcused absences will result in a deduction of your final grade. Not showing up to the final will result in a failing grade.

Schedule:

WEEK ONE: 9/5
- No class! Labor Day

WEEK TWO: 9/12
- In class: Introductions to each other and design as a field.
- Homework: Find two examples of what you'd consider "good" design, and two examples of what you'd consider "bad" design. Examples could be graphic design, a physical object or an interaction (like a website or physical process).
    - You'll upload these examples to Canvas and should be prepared to talk through your examples next week.

WEEK THREE: 9/19
- In class: You'll each talk through your examples of design. Intro to Figma and other designing tools. Intro to Hawaii Missile Interface project.
- Homework: Design an updated UI for Hawaii Missile Interface. Be ready to present your designs next week as well as discuss why you made the changes you did. Your design can take any format - you can draw the updated UI or use any online tool of your choosing.
    - You should upload your updated design to Canvas

WEEK FOUR: 9/26
- In class: We'll discuss our updated designs and have a group critique. Intro to journey mapping and next project. Form groups of 4-5 people for the next project, and brainstorm ideas come up with first iteration list
    - List of steps must be submitted via Canvas before leaving class
- Homework: V1 of journey map due in Canvas

WEEK FIVE: 10/3
- In class: each group will showcase their journey and we'll discuss as a group. In class you'll then have time together to work on your next iteration.

- Homework: Continue next iteration of journey map and decide on format for final deliverable (poster, online, drawn).
    - V2 of journey map due in Canvas
    - Chapter 1 reflection
    - NOTE: THESE ARE STILL DUE EVEN THOUGH WE WON'T MEET NEXT WEEK

WEEK SIX: 10/10

NO CLASS - Indigenous People Day

I will review your V2 draft and submit comments to you via Canvas. It is up for you all the connect outside of class to put together your final version

- Homework:
    - Finalize journey map and be prepared to showcase in class next week.
    - Chapter 2 reflection

WEEK SEVEN: 10/17

- In class: You'll have the first 30 minutes in class to finalize your journey map and decide how you will present it. Showcase final designs and we'll have a group critique. Intro to the next project. Sign up for the topic you'd like to explore. Although you'll have the same topic as others, this will be individual.
- Homework:
    - Discussion of light and dark side of your category
    - Chapter 3 reflection

WEEK EIGHT: 10/24

- In class: Co-creation workshop
- Homework:
    - Draft big idea and write how it answers the question
    - Chapter 4 reflection

WEEK NINE: 10/31 HAPPY HALLOWEEN

- In class: Intro to competitive audits and looking at a product landscape
    - I will provide feedback to your big idea via Canvas
- Homework:
    - Look at the space around your big idea - what similar sites/products exist in this space. Document where the ideas overlap, and how your idea is differentiated. Upload audit presentation
    - Chapter 5 reflection

WEEK TEN: 11/7

- NO CLASS -
- Review other audits for those students within your experience sphere
- Canvas discussion by experience sphere
    - I will provide feedback on your competitive landscape
- Watch video from IDEO founders
- Homework:
    - Discussion about video learnings - main post and 2 responses to others

    - Chapter 6 reflection

WEEK ELEVEN: 11/14

- In class: How to write a good discussion guide for concept feedback. Start building out your big idea.
- Homework:
    - Write discussion guide draft
    - Chapter 7 reflection

WEEK TWELVE: 11/21 Thanksgiving week

- In class: I will provide feedback on discussion guide
- Homework:
    - Interview 3 people on your big idea and gather feedback. Upload raw notes document as well as a few concise pieces of feedback you've learned
    - Chapter 8 reflection

WEEK THIRTEEN: 11/28

- In class: discussion about the process of interviewing others. Beyond the learnings around your Big idea, we'll have a discussion about what it's like to get this feedback from others. Class time to work on your big idea.
- Homework:
    - Finalize big idea presentation

WEEK FOURTEEN: 12/5:

- In class: Showcase final prototypes and be able to talk about overall learnings from the project and why you're recommending the new design.
- Homework: Have a good break!